Jay Stewart

Software engineer. Backend, payments and AI.

Remote contracts first; open to permanent or on-site for the right role

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PROFILE

Eight years of e-commerce and payments backends. Now I build and run SpiralClass in production with coding agents: real payments, live video with translated captions, and an LLM pipeline that turns each class into learning notes the teacher checks. Looking for remote contracts; open to a permanent or on-site role if it's the right one.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer (independent)

Mar 2026 – now

SpiralClass `live · real payments` Booking, payments and video for independent teachers. Built and run solo.

- Stripe Connect direct charges: the teacher is merchant of record; the platform never holds funds.
- Live captions translated in class: browser speech recognition, Deepgram for phones, on-device or Google translation. Recognition runs in the browser, so no server of mine handles the audio.
- Post-class LLM pipeline: Claude with forced tool calls and zod-validated output turns the transcript into findings the teacher confirms before they count. Consent-gated; models split by call shape for cost.
- Next.js, Postgres (82 models), LiveKit video. About 880 test files behind one merge gate. 146 decision records.

Career break

Mar 2020 – Mar 2026

Six years travelling on savings. Back because coding agents changed what one person can ship.

Backend Engineer · G&V | Venture Brands Agency (contract) · Bristol

Jul 2017 – Mar 2020

- Dyson's high-traffic stores, mainly Dyson India, in a team of about five. Built the "Book a demo" module; fixed production issues where an outage meant lost orders.

Full Stack Developer · Thrive Chiropractic (contract, remote)

Aug 2016 – Mar 2020

- Sole developer, front end to back end, from requirements with the practice to running their booking and payments platform.

Backend Engineer · Folk Digital, now We Are Folk, Poole; C3 Media, Bristol

Jul 2012 – Aug 2016

- Full stack at C3, from junior developer to whole sites; then backend at Folk on luxury fashion stores.

HOW I WORK

- **Care about money and production.** Payments reconcile to the right person; rules are tested against a real database.
- **Write things down.** A short update each day; decisions live in the pull request or issue.
- **I own what the agents write.** Every change gets a pull request and has to pass a merge gate of about 880 test files.

SKILLS

Stack	TypeScript, Next.js, React, Tailwind, Postgres (Neon), Prisma, Inngest, LiveKit
AI engineering	Claude API, structured outputs, prompt tests, Deepgram, Google speech and translation, Claude Code
Testing	Vitest, Playwright, visual regression, GitHub Actions, CodeQL
Payments and ops	Stripe Connect, Wise; Docker, Cloud Run, Cloudflare R2, OpenTofu, Sentry, PostHog
Languages	English (native), Spanish (conversational)